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CONTENTSYSTEM.AI

MODULE 6.2

Validation *Checks*

Before you commit time and money to a product, run it through these checks. Some confirm it converts. Others confirm the money actually makes sense.

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Validation *Checks*

Passing the core criteria is the first filter. Before you commit time and money to a product, run it through these checks. Some confirm the product converts. Others confirm the money actually makes sense.

The engagement and demand checks

CHECK ONE

Comment volume against views

The number of comments relative to views is a strong signal of how well a product converts. **As a rough benchmark, a video with around 100K views should be pulling 50 to 100 comments.** If a video has 100K views and only a handful of comments, that is a warning sign that the product does not move people to act.

CHECK TWO · THE MOST PREDICTIVE

Read what the comments actually say

There is a critical difference between engagement and demand.

ENGAGEMENT

"It's beautiful" · "Tag a friend" · generic praise. **No buying intent.**

DEMAND

"Where can I buy this" · asking for a link · asking the price. **Real purchase intent.**

Comments full of "where can I buy this" mean it converts. Comments full of "this is beautiful" with no buying questions often mean it does not. **This is one of the most reliable predictors of whether a product makes money.** The one exception: when the engagement ratio is extraordinarily high, the product can still convert even if not every comment is asking to buy. But that is the exception, not the rule.

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CHECK THREE

Check who is actually commenting

A comment count alone does not tell you the product makes money. **You have to look at who the commenters actually are**, because some demand never turns into sales.

Click on profiles asking where to buy. If they are clearly burner accounts themselves (no posts, no following, generic usernames, just scrolling and commenting on products), that is not a buyer. That is another operator scrolling their burner the same way you are.

Watch for low-converting regions. If the demand is mostly from countries where buyer payment systems, shipping costs, or income levels make orders rare, that demand will not turn into sales. The country mix matters as much as the count.

Watch for very young audiences. Twelve-, thirteen-, fourteen-year-olds typically do not have the money or means to buy. Not an automatic disqualification (sometimes the parent is the actual buyer, as covered in the ICP module), but a sea of teen comments with no adults is a weak signal.

When you check the comments, you are checking three things at once: **the count, the wording, and who they actually are**. All three matter.

GOING VIRAL FOR THE WRONG REASON

A video can go viral and the product can still make nothing, because the video went viral for the wrong reason. Controversy is the classic example. A video that gets explosive views because people are arguing in the comments, mocking it, or piling on for some unrelated reason will get views without buyers. **When a video pops, ask: are people responding to the product, or to something else in the video?** If it is the product, you have a real winner. If it is controversy or a generic concept that happened to spike, you do not.

The financial criteria

2–3×
MARKUP
Minimum from supplier cost to sale price.

$15+
PRICE FLOOR
Anything cheaper, bundle it.

50–80%
TARGET MARGIN
Where well-run stores in this model land.

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MARKUP

At least 2 to 3x supplier cost

If your supplier cost is $10, you want to sell for at least $20 to $30. **If the product does not have the perceived value to support at least a 2 to 3x markup, it may not be worth running.** There are exceptions with lower-margin products, that is your call, but treat this as the baseline.

PRICE FLOOR

The $15 floor

Do not sell anything under $15. If you are getting a product for $5 and its perceived value is $15 or less, the AOV is too low to be worth your time. People also read very cheap products as cheap, like disposable plastic, which hurts you. If a product is otherwise good but too cheap, the fix is to **bundle it. Two for $30 instead of one for $15.** Not every product is bundleable, so factor that in.

SOURCING

Can you actually source it

Make sure you can source the product from a supplier before you commit. **This matters more once you are past the beginner stage.** As a beginner, do not obsess over it, just get reps in. But people do occasionally go viral with a product they then cannot source anywhere, which is a waste of a winner. Double-check on a supplier platform that the product is actually available before you put serious effort behind it.

SANITY CHECK

Perceived value vs. selling price

Beyond the markup math, sanity-check the price against what the product feels worth. **If a product is being sold far above its perceived value, it will not convert** no matter how good the engagement looks. Research what comparable items go for so you can estimate perceived value, then compare to the asking price. A telltale sign of an overpriced product: a seller who keeps dropping the price over a few days, which usually means it was not converting higher.

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COMPETITION

How many stores are running it

Check how many stores are currently running the product. If you see it has been run for more than about two months, check back and decide whether it is still worth it. If you see something like ten competitors all running it in the same angle, either do not run it or run it in a different angle aimed at different people. **The full framework, the four questions and the red ocean idea, is in the next module.**